elements purged from the Iranian Army. Prime Minister Rajai charged that antirevolutionary elements had gathered under the banner of the President. Prosecutor General asserted that even the President could be called for questioning and investigation carried out as to what actually transpired after the President issued orders to deal with the troublemakers and the role played by the President's guards. Sadegh Khalkhali, a Shia Cleric called upon the Chief Justice and the Supreme Judicial Council to pronounce that Banisadr was politically

incompetent to hold the office of the President.

This internal fight for supremacy amid the Iran-Iraq war continued and the complaint against Banisadr reached Khomeini. R&AW spies watched as four thousand clergymen gathered in the town of Qom in March 1981, demanding action against the president. In response to the call of the clergy, the bazaars were partially closed in Tehran, and pro-clergy as well as pro-Banisadr processions were taken out.

After keeping silence on this issue for several days to avoid taking a firm position between the warring groups, Khomeini finally summoned sixteen top leaders from among Banisadr's and Rajai's supporters to his residence. Each leader, apart from stating his position on the matter, submitted a written statement for Khomeini's perusal. His office subsequently issued a ten-point communique to control the domestic chaos. It was made clear that since President Banisadr had been appointed the supreme commander of the armed forces by Khomeini, the president's authority must be acknowledged and all armed forces commanders should obey him. The president and the prime minister were told to not make public speeches until the end of the war and the clergy leading the Friday